Should this be a redesign?

A decision worksheet with a completed example and review criteria.

01	Start with the task, then state the proposed change.	02	Record an observation without turning it into a cause.
03	Write down the evidence you can inspect.	04	Choose the size of the response.
05	Compare your own two responses.	06	Use a rubric, not a vote on the mockup.
07	Plan a check that can change your mind.	08	Keep the decision and its limits together.

Start with the task, then state the proposed change.

Hypothetical example: a customer is comparing subscription plans. The proposal is to redesign the pricing page.

Keep the task specific enough to try. A broad goal such as improve conversion cannot explain which decision failed.

COMPLETED EXAMPLE

Compare two plans

A customer needs to find whether both plans include the feature they came for.

Customer and situation

Who is choosing, and what brings them to this screen?

Task and current proposal

What should they finish? What change has been proposed?

Record an observation without turning it into a cause.

An observation describes what happened. The explanation remains an interpretation until it has support.

Observation	Interpretation	Other explanation
The person opens both plan pages to find export limits.	The comparison does not explain the difference.	The plan names may also be unclear.
The person returns to pricing after reaching checkout.	A condition appeared too late.	They may be checking the billing period.
A founder dislikes the card style.	The visual direction needs discussion.	This says nothing yet about the customer task.

Write down the evidence you can inspect.

Separate the record from your explanation. A preference can be recorded honestly without being presented as customer evidence.

Observed action or words

What happened? Keep the wording or sequence as recorded.

Source and context

Where did it happen, when, and during which task?

Limit of the record

What does this observation leave unknown?

Choose the size of the response.

Compare a local change with a wider redesign. Write the dependency each introduces.

LOCAL CHANGE

Put export limits in the comparison

Keeps the structure. Requires a reliable source for each plan limit.

WIDER CHANGE

Rebuild the plan comparison

May help several difficult comparisons. Requires evidence across those decisions.

Compare your own two responses.

Use the completed pricing example as a guide. Give the smaller response a fair comparison with the proposed redesign.

Local response

Which specific obstruction would this change address?

Wider response

Which repeated cause would justify a larger change?

Dependency and cost

What needs to be settled, and what work does each response introduce?

Use a rubric, not a vote on the mockup.

These are decision criteria, not a score with a scientific cutoff. An unresolved critical dependency can outweigh several benefits.

Criterion	Evidence to inspect	Decision implication
Task obstruction	Can a person find the relevant plan difference?	Address a failed decision first.
Spread	Does the same issue recur in other key comparisons?	Consider wider work when the cause repeats.
Dependency	Are plan rules settled and available?	Resolve uncertain rules before presenting them.
Reversibility	Can the smaller change be tested and withdrawn?	Use it to learn when the cost is low.

Plan a check that can change your mind.

Give someone a plan-selection task without naming the feature location. Compare how they find and explain the relevant difference.

Question and task

What decision is difficult? What will the person try?

Observation to record

Where do they look? What do they believe is included?

Reason to revise

What result would make us reject our preferred response?

Keep the decision and its limits together.

Example decision: add export limits to the comparison before commissioning a full page redesign.

A successful task attempt supports this local change. It does not establish an effect on revenue.

Selected change and rationale

Name the response and the evidence behind it.

Uncertainty and boundary

What remains unknown? Which conclusion can we not make?

Owner and review date

Who will check the revised task, and when?